AN INVESTIGATION · DATA VISUALIZATIONS 2026

THE ITALIAN STAGNATION

A Multi-Lens Visual Investigation

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LUISS Guido Carli | *12 May 2026*

Motivation

"In Italia gli stipendi sono fermi"

a claim repeated everywhere in Italian discourse, almost never compared with peers.

Western European peers	*Italy*
+5 to +60%	**+3%**

real-wage growth, 1995 → 2024

Is the claim really true? And what does the gap cost individual workers?

Data

OECD

Average Annual Wages

real USD PPP, 1990–2024

Productivity

GDP per hour, 1995–2024

Taxing Wages

tax wedge, 18 countries, 2024

EUROSTAT

NUTS-2 GDP per capita

70 regions, 2000–2024 (EA20 baseline)

SBS firm size

firm size × productivity, 2020

HICP Italy

2014–2024 deflator

ISTAT

RACLI

median wage by age band, 2014–2023

Seven public datasets, three statistical agencies. All retrieved by hand from the providers' browser portals with explicit filter selections. EDA done on every dataset before committing to a chart form.

Design logic

An article you read, not a dashboard you query.

FORM FOLLOWS FUNCTION

Six charts, six different forms.

Each form chosen for what it reveals fastest.

EDITORIAL WRAPPING

Every chart wrapped in prose.

Setup paragraph → chart → findings paragraph.

CROSS-LINK FOR PAYOFF

From aggregate to personal.

Click a country in T1 → T5 calculator auto-fills.

The site

L I V E

filipponannucci.github.io/Data-visualization-project/

Switch to browser

JavaScript component

T5 · the personal calculator

WHAT IT DOES

Aggregate becomes personal.

Vanilla JS + D3.js. Three inputs: start year, comparator country, optional salary. Outputs: a € figure, an SVG trajectory, and concrete units (Vespas, pizzas, months of rent).

THE CROSS-LINK (T1 → T5)

Click a country, the calculator updates.

T1 sends a postMessage on click; T5 receives it, swaps the comparator, re-runs, and the page scrolls. This is what makes four charts "interactive and linked" per the brief.

In closing

WHAT WE FOUND

For three decades, Italian real wages have stayed flat.

Index 1995 = 100, real terms. Italy +3%, Spain +5%, Germany +22%, France +27%, OECD +31%, Sweden +62%. Source: OECD.

WHAT WE DON'T CLAIM

We document correlations, not causes.

Geopolitics, COVID, the energy shock and demographic ageing are absent from the analysis. They belong to the story; they are not in our charts.

Thank you. Questions?